

Interview of Female Manager at Riphah International Office

Interviewee	Ms Savera Saeed	Role	Manager at RIO
Date	2/13/2026	Time	1:18pm -2:26 pm
Venue	Online via Whatsapp	Subject	Exchange Program

Time	Question	Resopnse
4 minutes	Ma'am, basically for our FYP (Final Year Project), which starts in the seventh semester of Software Engineering, we solve a real-world problem. So, I have decided to study our university's Exchange Program Management System. I want to bring an AI revolution to it so that we can use AI to help facilitate this exchange program. For this, I want to study your current system and how the workflow currently operates. I have some questions related to this, so please answer them. So, first of all, I want to ask what your role is in this entire workflow and what your main day-to-day responsibilities are?"	Nabiha, as far as my duties are concerned, I am working here as a Manager at the Riphah International Office alongside Manager Mohsin. He is the male manager and I am the female manager. My work focuses more on visas; while Mohsin handles MOUs and university dealings, my job is to handle the visa documentation for students going abroad. Our entire process is such that we first hold awareness sessions at different campuses, and then interested students contact us. We apply for their admissions in universities; currently, we are dealing with Turkey, Malaysia, South Korea, Indonesia, and South Africa. We send student admissions to wherever seats are available. Each country has its own requirements, like South Korea requires a 3+ CGPA and IELTS, while Malaysia and Turkey don't have such specific conditions. Before admission, we also interview students to see if they are capable of living alone and handling daily tasks. After the offer letter arrives, we apply for the visa at the relevant embassy. Once they arrive there, we guide them regarding documentation like residence cards, university cards, and bus cards. We stay in touch during the six-month program and learn about their experiences upon return to improve for the next batch. Our team is headed by Sir Muhammad Nouman Mansoor, and it includes Mohsin Naveed, myself (Sawera Saeed), Nabigh (Deputy Manager), Aisha Omar Abbasi, and some interns
1 minute	Okay, Ma'am, how do you store and keep records of this entire workflow? How do you record it? Is there a digital application or interface? Or do you use things like Excel sheets and file management? Or do you have a complete portal-type system where everything is stored and recorded?	Nabiha, we use Excel sheets and Google Drive. We save student documents there and record dates, such as when the offer arrived, when we sent the application, when the visa was filed, and when the student is flying. We maintain all these things on Excel sheets and upload documents to Google Drive

30 seconds	How do you manage communication across departments and students?	in person, on call, via email, via departmental heads and advisors
3 minutes	If technology can make one part of your workflow easier what part would you like us to focus on	Nabiha, I think it would be helpful for us if we could give the students who are being finalized a link to that portal where they can upload all their updates. For example, which university offers have arrived or uploading required items for those offers. If a student needs a Bonafide certificate from our SSD department in Gulberg, they usually require an extract of results, father's CNIC, their own CNIC, and maybe a registration number. Currently, the student just goes there manually. It would be better if SSD also had access to the portal so they could see the uploaded documents and issue the required certificate. Students could upload their documents as they get ready, change their status themselves (like ticking off completed items), and we as team members could see everything from here. Right now, we have to call them and keep track manually, and sometimes students don't show up to the sessions we hold. This way, they can work from home and we can monitor it from here. For example, for the admission letter, we might ask them to upload the extract of results, Bonafide, recommendation, and passport copy to the portal. This would be instead of them WhatsApping or emailing us. Then, when it moves to the visa process, we can ask them to upload those specific documents there as well.
2 minutes	Okay, thank you Ma'am for your time. You have provided very helpful information that will allow us to build our system efficiently according to your requirements. If I have missed anything or if you want to add something, please let me know. Otherwise, JazakAllah Khair for your time."	Also, like I mentioned SSD, there should be a section for the Exam Department as well. They could login and provide the documents that departing students need, like result extracts or registration numbers. So, if there is software where three entities—Exams, SSD, and ourselves—can use it, that would be great."